

01

PROTOCOL

Co-founder Brief

Head of Marketing & Communications

Who we are looking for, what they would own, what they would not, and the terms we are ready to put on the table.

27%

BASE EQUITY

+9%

MILESTONES

90d

TRIAL ·
EQUITY ONLY

4y

VESTING,
1Y CLIFF

PREPARED FOR SUPERTeam IRELAND · DIARMUID

VOLTA TEAM · SLASHY · 2026-05-14

01 What Protocol 01 is, today

Protocol 01 is the privacy layer Solana doesn't have yet. Post-quantum ZK-STARKs (Winterfell, Poseidon over Goldilocks), stealth addresses (X25519 plus ML-KEM-768), on-chain verification. Solo built since end of January 2026.



The stack is live

Three client apps (mobile on Expo 54 with Android APK, a Chrome extension, a Next.js 16 web app). A STARK prover compiled to WASM. A growing family of SDKs (`zk-sdk` , `zksp1-sdk` , `specter-sdk` , `p01-js` , `arcium-sdk` , `privacy-toolkit` , `react-native-zk`). Shield, unshield, transfer, confidential balances, denominated pools, and Merkle update are all covered by STARK circuits that verify on-chain. A separate product, Mugen, layers P2P fiat-to-crypto with no KYC on top of the same primitives.

What just happened on the public side

Dev3pack Global Hackathon

Second place out of hundreds of teams on the Solana track. Behind AfterLife (Costa Rica), ahead of Commit (GitHub). 2026-05-11.

Colosseum Frontier submitted

Accelerator track application included. Team region Ireland (Superteam IE affiliation). Field-edit window open until 2026-05-10.

• Why this brief exists

The technical work is no longer the bottleneck. The product exists, the audit posture is good, two hackathon wins are on the board, and partnerships are starting to land. What is missing is someone who treats the story, the audience, and the channel mix with the same care and intensity that the codebase already gets.

Marketing, content, social, PR, narrative for investors and partners: these need a dedicated owner. Doing them on the side while shipping ZK circuits is no longer viable, and outsourcing them to an agency would produce the kind of generic crypto-content the protocol explicitly does not want. The right answer is a co-founder.

Built solo since end of January 2026 by one engineer. That same engineer is writing this brief.

02 Co-founder, Head of Marketing & Communications

You own the story, the audience, and every external touchpoint short of the actual business deals and the actual fundraiser.

What is in scope

Brand & narrative

The story we tell about why a privacy layer matters on Solana, and why Protocol 01 is the credible one. Positioning, voice, message hierarchy.

Content across formats

Long-form, threads, demos. Every release, every circuit, every program goes out with intent.

Video & motion

Take over our existing Remotion-based 4K render pipeline. Weekly updates that travel, release cuts, conference videos, vertical clips for X and YouTube Shorts, animated ZK explainers.

Social presence

A real X account, not a placeholder. A real cadence, not bursts around hackathons. Telegram, Discord, Superteam channels.

PR & podcasts

The right outlets, the right hosts, the right Twitter mutuels. The public face of the protocol when the founder cannot be in two places at once.

Audience growth

Numbers that go up, on the channels that matter. You define which channels matter and why, against owned and earned targets.

What is not in scope

AREA	WHY THE FOUNDER KEEPS IT
Business development	The founder handles partnerships, B2B SDK deals, ecosystem relationships (Solana Foundation, Superteam, Helius, Privy, Arcium, MagicBlock). You may surface leads and join meetings; you do not negotiate.
Fundraising	The founder leads investor conversations, owns the cap table, signs term sheets. You help build the deck and the data-room narrative; the round itself is not your domain.
Engineering & product	The technical roadmap, the protocol design, the security posture, and the release cadence are decided by the founder.

The asymmetry this creates is reflected in the equity terms on page 04.

03 Hard requirements, in order

None of the items below are negotiable. Each one has closed a door for us at least once already.

01 · Crypto-native

You already use Solana, hold a wallet, have an opinion on at least three existing privacy projects, and understand the difference between a SNARK and a STARK well enough to brief a journalist. You do not need to write circuits. You do need to follow them without translation.

02 · Fluency with ZK and privacy primitives

You can explain in plain language what a zero-knowledge proof is, what a SNARK versus STARK trade-off looks like, why post-quantum matters for signatures and for hashes, what a stealth address protects (and what it does not), what Arcium-style MPC adds on top of pure ZK, and where ML-KEM-768 fits in our stealth pipeline. You can read a Poseidon, Merkle, or commitment-scheme reference without losing the room.

Aztec

Penumbra

Aleo

Nocturne

Tornado

Railgun

Light

Elusiv

Umbra

Arcium

Familiarity with any of these is the baseline. Familiarity with none is a hard stop. Every founder, every investor, every podcast host in this niche tests you on this in the first ninety seconds.

03 · Solana / Ireland network, real and live

Superteam IE is the obvious starting point, but the bar is higher than "I am in the Telegram". You have shipped something, organised something, written something, or onboarded someone here, and people answer when you DM them.

04 · Demonstrable crypto comms output

Not "I ran ads for a SaaS in 2022". Threads that performed, content that travelled, a project whose narrative you can take partial credit for, a community you grew, a launch you led. We will ask to see it.

05 · Motion design & video editing

This is a hard requirement, not a bonus. You can take a brief and ship a finished 60-second cut on your own: timeline, motion, sound, captions, export. Tooling is open (After Effects, Premiere, DaVinci, Final Cut, Remotion if you code, anything else that ships) but the output bar is high. Bring a reel.

Non-crypto reel that is visually sharp works. Crypto reel that is slow and templated does not.

06 · Excellent written English

The narrative for Protocol 01 is currently in two languages and needs to consolidate, sharpen, and travel. You will write a lot.

07 · Comfort with the founder's working style

Solo for four months, async days, plain prose over emoji-heavy decks, low tolerance for marketing clichés ("revolutionary", "game-changing", "unlocks").

04 What sweetens the deal, and what we put on the table

Nice to have, not required

Prior co-founder experience

Even at a smaller scale. You know what the first eighteen months feel like, how to disagree with a co-founder without escalating, and you have seen at least one fundraise from inside.

Past privacy / infra track record

On Solana, Ethereum, Cosmos, or Polkadot. Bonus if you have lived through the gap between "the protocol works" and "the protocol is understood".

Code-aware motion work

Familiarity with Remotion or any code-first motion stack (Manim, GSAP, Lottie). Our pipeline already does chunked GPU 4K renders with FFmpeg concat; someone who can extend it directly moves twice as fast.

Spoken French · on-camera comfort

French is useful given where the founder is based. Comfort on video, podcast, or stage is useful because we need a public face that is not only the founder, and we need it sooner than later.

Commitment & terms

Both sides need an honest exit ramp before the larger equity grant is on the table, and a single product is at risk if either side locks in too early. The proposal is an equity-only 90-day trial followed by full-time co-founder status.

PHASE	FORMAT	TERMS
90-day trial	Part-time / equity-only 10 to 15 h/week	Agreed deliverables: a six-month communications plan, a refreshed narrative document, a first cycle of outbound, and a relaunch of the public X presence. Equity-only trial: 2% advisor grant, cliffed at successful 90-day completion. No cash compensation.
Full-time	Co-founder 27% common stock	Four-year vesting, one-year cliff, monthly thereafter. The vesting clock backdates to day one of the trial; the cliff unlocks only at confirmed full-time start. The 2% advisor grant from the trial period remains acquired in addition to the 27% base.
Milestones	Up to +9% Cap at 38%	Performance-linked equity, agreed in writing before full-time start. Examples (non-binding): audience targets, named tier-one press, contribution to a closed round, B2B SDK deals where comms materially shortened the cycle.

Cash compensation

No cash during pre-funding phase. This is an equity-only co-founder path. A market-rate salary floor is written into the full-time contract, triggered once a funding round closes.

Location

Remote-first. Dublin presence is a plus, not a requirement.

05 What you are walking into

Honest version, because that is the only kind worth reading. You are betting on a strong product in a hard category, not on a Series A track record.

Why this is a good bet

- Technically very advanced for a four-month-old solo effort. The hardest engineering risk is largely behind us.
- Two recent public signals: Dev3pack #2 worldwide on the Solana track, Colosseum Frontier submitted with accelerator track.
- The first 60 days of marketing work are obvious. You will not be inventing problems to solve.
- Your domain is unowned today. You start with full ownership from day one, not a turf battle.

Why this is a hard bet

- Personal runway has been burned. We are entering a fundraising phase that is not yet certain to land.
- No real X presence, no content cadence, no narrative document anyone outside the founder's head can read.
- Cash compensation is below market until a round closes. Equity is the real instrument.
- Solo-built codebases are intimate. You will need to earn trust in your domain the way the founder earned it in his.

The founder

Publishes as **Slashy** under the **Volta Team** handle on X, GitHub, and Superteam channels. Direct, technical, French, currently based in Ireland. Will give you ownership of your domain and expect you to use it. Will push back hard when the comms output drifts toward clichés or generic crypto-Twitter performance theatre. Both of those are features, not bugs.

"Built the protocol alone for four months.
Looking for the person who tells the world about it."

Recent traction worth knowing

SIGNAL	DATE	WHY IT MATTERS
Dev3pack #2 worldwide	2026-05-11	Solana track. Independent technical validation against hundreds of teams.
Demo Day live on X	2026-05-12	First project to go live in the demo window. Disney+ subscribe flow as headline demo.
Colosseum Frontier	2026-05 (open)	Submission with accelerator track application. Team region Ireland.
14 programs · devnet live	Ongoing	All six STARK circuits verify on-chain. Mobile, web, extension shipping V4 pools.

06 Three steps, then a one-week micro-engagement

Designed to respect everyone's time. No deck or full CV asked at step one.

Step 01 • Written exchange

Send a short note plus three artefacts:

- One link to a piece of comms work you are proud of.
- One link to a piece of motion or video work you are proud of.
- One paragraph: your take on what Protocol 01's positioning should be.

Step 02 • Video call with the founder

Forty-five minutes. We talk about the protocol, about your work, about how we would split decisions. No prepared questions, just a real conversation.

Step 03 • Equity-aligned micro-engagement

One week, one deliverable (a short positioning document or a thread on a current release). Counts toward the trial's 2% advisor grant. Both sides validate the working rhythm before signing the 90-day trial.

If all three go well, we sign the 90-day trial agreement and start within two weeks.

What to send, and where

Reply via the Superteam Ireland channel Diarmuid forwarded along with this document. Subject line: **"Protocol 01 co-founder • [your name]"**. The founder writes back personally.

If you are unsure whether to apply

Apply anyway. The two hardest filters in this brief are crypto-nativeness and motion-design output. If you are confident on those two, the rest is conversation. If you are uncertain on one, say so up front in your note. We would rather know.

Thank you for reading

This brief is intentionally short. If a question is missing here, ask it in your first note.

VOLTA TEAM • SLASHY • PROTOCOL 01
protocol-01.dev • github.com/IsSlashy/Protocol-01